What I didn’t really expect was the hype around the hearing on the day that I was scheduled to appear. I had woken up feeling really nervous that morning, and seeing the number of reporters and photographers waiting outside the building just amped me up even more. I had managed to make it to Peter’s offices relatively unseen, but walking from his office to the court, man, that was another story. The number of reporters and cameras outside the courthouse was just scary. And then I walked into the courtroom and it was packed to the rafters. It was full, full, full – 10 rows deep. I was so nervous I couldn’t even take the oath properly. When they said, ‘Please raise your right hand,’ I put up my left hand.

Shamila Batohi had a pretty hard-core reputation, and she now also had a very public platform on which to make her name. Surprisingly, though, she didn’t come at me quite as hard as we expected. Peter had also prepared me well, though. There was one key question that Peter and I knew would be coming and it was crucial that I get the answer right. It wasn’t a matter of lying, but just of making sure that I used the correct words.

Peter, though, was really worried that I might get the words wrong, as I was so nervous. As it turned out, I absolutely nailed the answer. I was very happy with how I conducted myself in the end. The way in which I gave my answers was both honest and professional. The toughest thing by far was apologising to everyone on worldwide TV – I would never like to be in a similar position again. I couldn’t stop the tears …

As you can well imagine, it was a huge relief to get the in terrogation behind me and escape to Advocate Mike Fitzgerald’s chambers. Straight away, I had a shot of whisky and a cigarette. Hansie was there too. He was wearing this really awful tie with ducks on it. I said, ‘Jeez, bru, the amount of money you’ve got and you still bought a tie with fucking ducks on?’ Hansie packed up laughing. He then apologised again for getting me into this mess, but I told him not to worry; we were both to blame.

After hearing testimony from other players and Hansie himself, proceedings wrapped up. On 28 August, the UCB announced that Henry Williams and I would be banned from playing international cricket for six months. Henry was fined R10 000 and I was fined R60 000. But that was nothing compared to Hansie’s punishment. On 11 October, the UCB announced that Hansie was banned from playing and coaching cricket for life. Naturally I wasn’t happy with my sentence – not only did I not take